

62. Consider the following

1. Assessment of land revenue on the basis of nature of the soil and the quality of crops.
2. Use of mobile cannons in warfare.
3. Cultivation of tobacco and red chillies.

Which of the above was/were introduced into India by the English?

- (a) Only 1 (b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3 (d) None of these

I.A.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (d)

The assessment of land revenue on the basis of nature of the soil and the quality of crops was introduced during the reign of Sher Shah Suri and Akbar much before the British. The cultivation of tobacco and red chillies in India was contributed by Portuguese and mobile cannons in warfare were introduced in the Mughal Era. There were various types of cannons manufactured in the ordinance factory of Akbar. Thus, none of the above was introduced into India by the English.

63. Who remarked about the East India Company that

"The Company is an anomaly but it is part of a system where everything is an anomaly"?

- (a) Warren Hastings (b) G.B. Macaulay
(c) Lord Clive (d) Henry Dundas

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

Lord Thomas Babington Macaulay was a British politician and historian. He was the Law Member in the Supreme Council of India and the head of the Law Commission from 1834 to 1838 A.D. He had prepared the manuscript of the famous Penal Law book 'The Indian Penal Code'. He had an important role in making English the official language and medium of education of India and European Literature, Philosophy and Science the goal of Indian education. Commenting on the policies of the East India Company, Macaulay said that "The company is an anomaly, but it is part of a system where everything is anomaly.

64. With reference to the Treaty of "Aix-la-Chapelle-1748" which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The 1st Carnatic War was ended.
2. The English got back Madras.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

Codes :

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans (c)

Austrian war of succession ended with the Treaty of "Aix-la-Chapelle-1748 A.D.". With the end of Europe's war, 1st War of Carnatic also ended and Britishers got back Madras. Hence, option (c) is correct.

65. With reference to "the causes of the success of British and failure of the French in India" which of the following statement is/are correct?

1. Getting huge wealth and manpower from Conquest of Bengal by British.

2. Naval superiority of the British.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below.

Codes:

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P.R.O. / A.R.O. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2016

Ans (c)

There were many causes of the success of the British in India. Naval superiority, getting huge wealth and manpower from Bengal, better internal coordination among British army etc. were few of them.

East India Company and Nawabs of Bengal

*Murshid Quli Khan was the last Governor of Bengal who was independently appointed by Mughal King.

Murshid Quli Khan shifted his Capital to **Maksudabad** from Dhaka and named it **Murshidabad**. He started Izara System in the land settlement. ***Alivardi Khan** (1740-1756 A.D.) comparing Europeans with the Honeybees, said that if they are left undisturbed, they will give you honey, and if try to disturb them they will bite you till death. *After the death of Alivardi Khan, his grandson **Siraj-ud-Daula** succeeded to the throne of Bengal. **The Black Hole tragedy** took place during his reign on 20th June 1756 A.D. According to one of the 23 survivors, J.Z. Holwell, 146 English prisoners were put in a cell with a dimension of 18 feet in length and 14 feet 10 inches in breadth. 123 of them died due to suffocation and only 23 survived. This incident is known as **Black Hole tragedy**. Contemporary Muslim historian **Ghulam Hussain** in his book 'Siyar-ul-Mutakherin' has not mentioned this incident. *Robert Clive is known as the founder of the English Empire in India who defeated the forces of Bengal's Nawab Siraj-ud-Daula in the Battle of Plassey (presently known as Palasi) on 23rd June, 1757 A.D. and sown the seeds of British rule in India. The Battlefield of Plassey is situated on the Banks of Bhagirathi River in Nadia district of West Bengal. Robert Clive was the Governor in 1758-60 A.D. and **1765-67 A.D.** in India. During this period he signed **Allahabad Treaty** with Nawab of Awadh Shuja-ud-Daula. During his governorship **White Mutiny** broke out among English soldiers.* Plundering of resources of Bengal by the British Company was started during Clive's governorship. *Mir Qasim (1760-63 A.D.) was the ablest among the successors of Alivardi Khan. As a 'Faujdar' of Poornia and Rangpur, Mir Qasim had already proven his

ability. To save his courtiers from repeated conspiracies by Britishers and to avoid interference from Englishmen, Mir Qasim shifted his Capital to Munger from Murshidabad so as to stay away from Calcutta. He consolidated his army using European methods. He made arrangements in Munger for the manufacturing of **Matchlock guns**. Mir Qasim also took some brave steps so as to improve the economic conditions in Bengal. The officers involved in embezzlement were fined heavily, some new taxes were introduced. *The Combined forces of Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula (Nawab of Awadh), and Mughal King Shah Alam II were defeated by Britishers in the Battle of Buxar on **22/23 October, 1764 AD**. English army was led by **Hector Munro**. **Henry Vansittart** was the then Governor of Bengal. This victory of Britishers made the English a great power in northern India and contenders for supremacy over the whole country. Now, there was no one in India who could challenge the British. The area up to Allahabad was now under the British and the door of Delhi was now open for British. Battle of Buxar changed the course of Indian History. During this battle, **Mir Jafar** was Nawab of Bengal and Delhi was ruled by **Shah Alam II**. By the treaties of Allahabad (August, 1765) Shah Alam II agreed to reside at Allahabad, under the company's protection. Nawab Shuja-ud-Daula surrendered Allahabad and Kara to Emperor Shah Alam II. *Shah Alam II issued a decree granting **Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa** to the East India Company. ***Robert Clive** became the governor of Bengal and started **Dual government** system in Bengal. *The Company appointed two deputy Diwans, **Mohammad Raza Khan** for Bengal and **Raja Shitab Roy** for Bihar to exercise Diwani functions. During the time of Shah Alam II in 1803, Delhi fell completely to Britishers. Shah Alam II and his two successors Akbar II (1806-37 AD) and Bahadur Shah II (1837-57 AD) were mere pensioners of the East India Company. *The British came to Sylhet in 1765 AD after acquiring the Diwani right of Bengal. After the War of Burma, **David Scott** tried to connect Sylhet through roads to Jaintia and Garo Hill areas, but faced a very tough resistance from the Khasi tribes who lived in these areas under the leadership of **Tirot Sing**. ***K.M. Pannikar** said that from 1765 to 1772 AD the Company made Bengal a 'State of Dacoits'.

1. Which one of the following was the last Governor of Bengal appointed by the Mughal Emperor?

- (a) Sarfraz Khan
- (b) Murshid Quli Khan
- (c) Alivardi Khan
- (d) Shujauddin Muhammad Khan

U.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b)

Farrukh Siyar, the Mughal Emperor, promoted Murshid Quli Khan as the Governor of Bengal in 1717 A.D. Shujauddin, the son-in-law of Murshid Quli Khan, became the Governor of Bengal after the death of Murshid Quli Khan who was duly ratified by the Mughal Emperor Muhammad Shah "Rangeela". Hence his Father-in-law was the last Governor of Bengal appointed by Mughal emperor independently.

2. The last Subedar of Bengal, who was appointed by Mughal Emperor -

- (a) Murshid Quli Khan
- (b) Sarfraz Khan
- (c) Shuja-ud-Din Muhammad Khan
- (d) Alivardi Khan

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre.) 2021

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. Which of the following war began the consolidation of British supremacy over India?

- (a) Battle of Buxar
- (b) Battle of Plassey.
- (c) IIIrd Battle of Mysore
- (d) Independence Struggle of 1857

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

British supremacy was established in India from the Battle of Plassey. British defeated Nawab Sirajuddaula in the battle of Plassey on 23 June, 1757 AD under the command of Robert Clive. Nawab's army was under the command of three traitors- Mir Jafar, Yar Latif Khan and Rai Durlabh. Siraj fled from the battlefield to Murshidabad due to adverse circumstances of war. It finally resulted in his defeat. This victory provided instant military and commercial benefits to Britishers. Battle of Plassey set the ground for British political dominion over three leading states of agriculture and Handcrafting: Bihar, Bengal, and Orissa. Battle of Plassey founded the British empire in India, however, it was the Battle of Buxar (1764 AD) that actually established British superiority in India.

4. The first decisive military success of English East India Company in India is marked by -

- (a) Battle of Buxar
- (b) Battle of Plassey
- (c) Battle of Panipat
- (d) Battle of Haldighati

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. The Battle of Plassey was fought in the year.

- (a) 1761
- (b) 1757
- (c) 1760
- (d) 1764

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. Sirajuddaula was defeated by Lord Clive in the battle of-

- (a) Plassey
- (b) Buxar

- (c) Munger (d) Wandiwash
U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (a)

Sirajuddaula was defeated by Lord Clive in the battle of Plassey in 1757 A.D.

7. Who was the founder of the British Empire in India?
(a) Warren Hastings
(b) Lord Amherst
(c) Lord Robert Clive
(d) Lord William Bentinck

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (c)

Robert Clive was the founder of the British Empire in India and consolidated British supremacy by defeating Nawab of Bengal Sirajuddaula in the battle of Plassey (23 June, 1757 A.D.).

8. Who among the following has been called as a "Heaven Born General" ?
(a) Albuquerque (b) Robert Clive
(c) Francois Duplex (d) Lord Cornwallis
U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (b)

Robert Clive was the Governor of Bengal twice from 1758-1760 A.D. and then from 1765-1767 A.D. He forced Nawab of 'Oudh' Shujaudaula and Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II to sign the Treaty of Allahabad. He established "Predatory State" in Bengal successfully. Indeed, he was a statesman in the mask of a soldier. William Pitt stated that he was "Heaven-Born General."

9. The battlefield of Plassey is situated in –
(a) Bihar (b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Orissa (d) West Bengal
Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

Plassey (present name - Palasi) battlefield is located on the banks of the Bhagirathi River in Nadia district of West Bengal. On 23 June 1757 AD, the troops of the British East India Company led by Robert Clive defeated Nawab of Bengal Sirajuddaula, in the historic Battle of Plassey.

10. Which of the following shifted his capital from Murshidabad to Munger?
(a) Alivardi Khan (b) Siraj-ud-Daula
(c) Mir Jafar (d) Mir Qasim

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

Mir Qasim was the most efficient successor among the successors of Nawab Alivardi Khan. He demonstrated his capability as Fauzdar of Poornia and Rangpur. He transferred his capital from Murshidabad to Munger. The reason was to secure himself from constant interference from Calcutta and intrigues of Murshidabad. He organized his Army on the European model. He managed the factory of arms and ammunition at Munger for manufacturing of tanks and matchlock guns. Besides, Mir Qasim had made efforts to reform state's financial condition.

11. The most decisive battle that led to the establishment of supremacy of the British in India was :
(a) The Battle of Buxar
(b) The Battle of Plassey
(c) The Battle of Wandiwash
(d) The Third Battle of Panipat

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2003

U.P. U.D.A./ L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 1990

Ans. (a)

On 22/23 October, 1764 A.D. British Army defeated allied forces of Mir Qasim, Nawab of Oudh Shuja-ud-Daula and Mughal emperor Shah Alam II. British Army's command was in the hands of Major Hector Munro in the Battle of Buxar. The battle of Buxar assured the result of Plassey battle and established British supremacy on Banaras and Allahabad (Prayagraj) across the Ganges. The battle of Buxar made way for British and proved that there was no strong competitor before the British. The battle of Buxar completed what Plassey had begun. According to Sir James Stephen, "The battle of Buxar deserves more credit than the battle of Plassey as the origin of British power in India". If the results of both significant battles are analyzed, it can be said that the battle of Plassey was won by treachery, but the battle of Buxar showed the supremacy of English armies and military skills. Plassey made the English the only controllers of Bengal while Buxar raised the political prestige of the Company throughout India.

12. Out of the following, the most decisive battle fought by the English East India Company was
(a) Battle of Buxar (b) Battle of Plassey
(c) First Anglo-Sikh War (d) First Anglo-Mysore War
U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

13. Which one of the following is considered to be the most significant battle in the establishment of British supremacy in India?
(a) Buxar (b) Plassey
(c) Shrirangpattam (d) Wandiwash

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

14. Who was the ruler of Delhi at the time of the battle of Buxar?

- (a) Aurangzeb (b) Shah Alam I
(c) Bahadur Shah Zafar (d) Shah Alam II

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

15. Who was the Nawab of Bengal when the Battle of Buxar was fought?

- (a) Sirajuddaula (b) Mir Jafar
(c) Mir Qasim (d) Najmuddaula

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

The Battle of Buxar was fought on 22/23 October 1764 A.D. between the forces under the command of the British East India Company led by Hector Munro and the combined Army of Mir Qasim, Mughal King Shah Alam-II and Nawab of Awadh. Mir Jafar was the Nawab of Bengal then.

16. Which treaty was signed after the Battle of Buxar?

- (a) The Treaty of Allahabad (b) The Treaty of Sugauli
(c) The Treaty of Bassein (d) The Treaty of Salbai

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

The Treaty of Allahabad (1765 A.D.) was signed after the Battle of Buxar (1764 A.D.).

17. Which one of the following rulers had granted Diwani to the East India Company?

- (a) Farukhsiyar (b) Shah Alam- I
(c) Shah Alam- II (d) Shujauddaula

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

As per the first Treaty of Allahabad (August 1765 A.D.), the Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II was taken under the Company's protection and was to reside at Allahabad. The Emperor issued an order dated 12th August, 1765 granting Company the Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa. During this time Robert Clive was Governor of East India Company in Bengal. The emperor's order legalized the political authority of Company in Bengal and British rule expanded all over India including Delhi. Successors of Shah Alam II i.e. Akbar II (1806-37 A.D.) and Bahadurshah II (1837-57 A.D.) became pensioners of East India Company.

18. Who granted the Diwani of Bengal to the East India Company in 1765?

- (a) Nawab of Bengal (b) Mughal Emperor
(c) British Monarch (d) The Afghan King

U.P. P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the the above question.

19. In which Governor's tenure, Diwani rights of Bengal, Bihar and Odisha was granted to East India Company by Emperor Shah Alam?

- (a) Lord Clive (b) Lord Cornwallis
(c) Lord Wellesley (d) Lord William Bentinck

U.P. P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

20. Emperor Shah Alam- II gave the Diwani of Bengal - Bihar and Orissa to East India Company on -

- (a) 12 August, 1765 (b) 18 August, 1765
(c) 29 August, 1765 (d) 21 August, 1765

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

21. Who was appointed Deputy Diwan of Murshidabad by Robert Clive after the Allahabad Treaty?

- (a) Mohd. Raza Khan (b) Shitab Rai
(c) Rai Durlabh (d) Syed Ghulam Hussain

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

According to the Treaty of Allahabad (August, 1765 A.D.), Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II was taken under the Company's protection and had to reside at Allahabad. Shah Alam II conferred Diwani (fiscal revenue collection authority) of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa to the Company by issuing 'Farman' on 12 August, 1765 A.D. In return, the company had to pay the emperor an annual sum of Rs 26 Lakhs as pension. At that time, the Company was neither interested in taking responsibility for tax revenue collection nor was it capable of doing so. Therefore, the Company appointed two Diwans- Mohammad Raza Khan for Bengal and Raja Shitab Rai for Bihar. Thus, all business of Diwani and Nizamat was conducted by Indians but authorized by the British Company.

22. With which one of the following mountain tribes did the British first come into contact with after the grant of Diwani in the year 1765?

- (a) Garo (b) Khasi
(c) Kuki (d) Tipperah

I.A.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (b)

The British came to Sylhet in 1765 AD after acquiring the Diwani of Bengal and David Scott tried to link Sylhet with Jaintia and Garo's hilly areas by road routes after the Burma War. Khasi tribe revolted under the leadership of Tirot Sing.

23. With reference to the Hindu Nayab Wazirs of Oudh Sultanate, which of the following statements(s) is/are correct?

1. Raja Tikait Rai was 'Artha Mantri' of Nawab Aasafudaullah.
2. Usually, there were certain Hindu castes who were placed at the high positions in the State of Nawabs of Oudh.

Select the correct answer from the code given below.

Code:

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P.R.O. / A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans (c)

Raja Tikait Rai was Artha Mantri or diwan of Nawab Aasafudaullah of Oudh. Usually certain Hindu castes were placed in high positions in the state of Nawabs of Oudh. Hence, the option (c) is correct.

24. Which one of the following is the correct chronological order of the battles fought in India in the 18th Century?

- (a) Battle of Wandiwash-Battle of Buxar-Battle of Ambur-Battle of Plassey
- (b) Battle of Ambur-Battle of Plassey-Battle of Wandiwash-Battle of Buxar
- (c) Battle of Wandiwash-Battle of Plassey-Battle of Ambur-Battle of Buxar.
- (d) Battle of Ambur-Battle of Buxar-Battle of Wandiwash-Battle of Plassey.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Battle of Ambur (August, 1749 A.D.):- The combined armies of Muzaffar Jung, Chanda Sahib and the French defeated and Killed Anwar-ud-din at the Battle of Ambur near Bellore in August, 1749. Muzaffar Jung became the Subedar of Deccan. Duplex was appointed Governor of all the Mughal territories south of the river Krishna. The Nizam surrendered some districts in the northern circars to the French. A French army under Bussy was stationed in Hyderabad.

Battle of Plassey (June, 1757 A.D.):- Fought between Nawab of Bengal Sirajuddaula and the British Army. Bengal was in control of the British after Plassey. Mir Jafar was placed on the throne by Robert Clive. In exchange, Mir Jafar ceded an area of the south of Calcutta known as 24 Pargana to the British for their services and gifted 2,34,000 pounds to Clive as personal gift reward.

Battle of Wandiwash (January, 1760 A.D.) :- It occurred between French and British. French were defeated by the British. Sir Eyre Coote was the leader of the British Army while French troops were led by Count de Lally.

Battle of Buxar (October, 1764 A.D.) :- Fought between allied forces of Mir Qasim, Shujauddaula, Shah Alam II and the British. British led by Hector Munro defeated the allied forces badly. Thus, option (b) will be the correct answer.

25. Name the French Commander who was defeated in the battle of Wandiwash in 1760.

- (a) Count Lally (b) Francis Martin
(c) Dupleix (d) None of the above

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

26. In the Battle of Wandiwash (1760) –

- (a) French defeated British
- (b) British defeated British
- (c) British defeated French
- (d) Dutch defeated British

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

27. The famous Battle of Wandiwash in 1760 was fought by the British against whom?

- (a) The French (b) Spain
- (c) Mysore (d) Carnatic
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

28. Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched?

- (a) Battle of Buxar – Mir Jafar Vs. Clive
- (b) Battle of Wandiwash – French Vs. East India Company
- (c) Battle of Chillianwala – Dalhousie Vs. Marathas
- (d) Battle of Khurda – Nizam Vs. East India Company

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

Battle of Buxar (October, 1764 A.D.), was fought between Allied Forces of Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula and Shah Alam II, and British force. British force led by Hector Munro defeated the Allied forces badly. The battle of Buxar is regarded as the first decisive military success of the English East India Company in India.